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# CHAPTER 2

## Expansion of British Power in India (Part 3)

### Conquest of the Maratha Confederacy

#### Introduction

After defeating Mysore, the British faced the **Maratha Confederacy**, the strongest Indian political power in western and central India.

The struggle continued through **three Anglo-Maratha Wars**, ending with the complete defeat of the Marathas and British supremacy over most of India.

#### What was the Maratha Confederacy?

The Maratha Confederacy was a **group of powerful Maratha states** united under the **Peshwa**.

##### Important Exam Facts

- The **Peshwa** was the head of the Maratha Confederacy.
- Important Maratha chiefs included **Sindhia, Holkar and Bhonsle**.
- Internal conflicts among these chiefs weakened the Confederacy.
- The British used these internal disputes to expand their power.

#### First Anglo-Maratha War (1775–82)

##### What was it?

This was the first major war between the British and the Marathas.

##### Important Exam Facts

- **Nana Phadnavis** violated his agreement with the English by giving a port to the French.
- The English marched towards **Pune**.
- The British surrendered and signed the **Treaty of Wadgaon**.
- **Warren Hastings** rejected the Treaty of Wadgaon.
- Colonel **Goddard** captured **Ahmedabad** and **Bassein**.

- **Sindhia** helped negotiate peace.
- The war ended with the **Treaty of Salbai**, which ensured peace for **20 years**.

## Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803–05)

### What was it?

Internal fighting among the Marathas gave the British an opportunity to interfere.

### Important Exam Facts

- **Jaswantrao** defeated the armies of the Peshwa and Sindhia.
- **Bajirao II** fled to **Bassein**.
- He signed the **Treaty of Bassein** with the British for military help.
- The Peshwa accepted the **Subsidiary Alliance**.
- **Sindhia**, **Bhonsle** and **Holkar** resisted the British.
- **Arthur Wellesley** defeated the combined Maratha forces.
- Separate treaties were signed with the defeated Maratha chiefs.

## Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817–19)

### What was it?

This was the final war that ended Maratha independence.

### Important Exam Facts

- **Lord Hastings** took action against the **Pindaris**.
- **Bajirao II** united the Maratha chiefs against the British.
- The Peshwa attacked the British Residency at **Poona**.
- The British defeated:
  - **Peshwa** at **Khirki**
  - **Bhonsle** at **Sitabuldi**
  - **Holkar** at **Mahidpur**
- In **1818**, Bajirao II surrendered.
- The **Peshwaship** was **abolished**.
- The **Maratha Confederacy** came to an end.

## Important Personalities

| Personality      | Importance                                                   |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nana Phadnavis   | Important Maratha leader during the First Anglo-Maratha War. |
| Warren Hastings  | Rejected the Treaty of Wadgaon.                              |
| Colonel Goddard  | Captured Ahmedabad and Bassein.                              |
| Sindhia          | Helped conclude the Treaty of Salbai.                        |
| Jaswantrao       | Defeated the armies of the Peshwa and Sindhia.               |
| Bajirao II       | Signed the Treaty of Bassein with the British.               |
| Arthur Wellesley | Defeated the combined Maratha armies.                        |
| Lord Hastings    | Led the British during the Third Anglo-Maratha War.          |

## Important Places

| Place        | Importance                                            |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Pune (Poona) | Centre of the Peshwa and attack on British Residency. |
| Ahmedabad    | Captured by Colonel Goddard.                          |
| Bassein      | Treaty of Bassein signed here.                        |
| Khirki       | Peshwa defeated here.                                 |
| Sitabuldi    | Bhonsle defeated here.                                |
| Mahidpur     | Holkar defeated here.                                 |

## Important Wars / Treaties

| Name                      | Importance                                  |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Treaty of Wadgaon         | British surrendered during the First War.   |
| Treaty of Salbai          | Ended the First Anglo-Maratha War.          |
| Treaty of Bassein         | Peshwa accepted British protection.         |
| Treaty of Devgaon         | Signed after Bhonsle's defeat.              |
| Treaty of Surajianjangaon | Signed after Sindhia's defeat.              |
| Treaty of Rajpurghat      | Signed after Holkar's defeat.               |
| Treaty of Poona           | Signed with the Peshwa after the Third War. |
| Treaty of Gwalior         | Signed with Sindhia.                        |
| Treaty of Mandasor        | Signed with Holkar.                         |

## Important Years

| Year    | Event                    |
|---------|--------------------------|
| 1775–82 | First Anglo-Maratha War. |
| 1782    | Treaty of Salbai.        |
| 1802    | Treaty of Bassein.       |

|         |                                                                 |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1803–05 | Second Anglo-Maratha War.                                       |
| 1817–19 | Third Anglo-Maratha War.                                        |
| 1818    | End of the Maratha Confederacy and abolition of the Peshwaship. |

## Frequently Confused Facts

| Question                                  | Correct Answer    |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Treaty ending the First Anglo-Maratha War | Treaty of Salbai  |
| British surrender in the First War        | Treaty of Wadgaon |
| Treaty signed by Bajirao II               | Treaty of Bassein |
| British commander in the Second War       | Arthur Wellesley  |
| Governor-General in the Third War         | Lord Hastings     |
| End of the Maratha Confederacy            | 1818              |
| Office abolished after the Third War      | Peshwaship        |
| Community targeted by Lord Hastings       | Pindaris          |

## Previous Year Exam Focus

- Maratha Confederacy.
- Peshwa.
- Nana Phadnavis.
- Treaty of Wadgaon.
- Treaty of Salbai.
- Treaty of Bassein.
- Arthur Wellesley.
- Lord Hastings.
- Pindaris.
- Khirki.
- Sitabuldi.
- Mahidpur.
- End of Peshwaship.
- End of the Maratha Confederacy.
- Important treaties with Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar.

# Expected MCQ Areas

- Three Anglo-Maratha Wars.
- Treaty of Bassein.
- Treaty of Salbai.
- Bajirao II.
- Arthur Wellesley.
- Lord Hastings.
- Pindaris.
- Peshwaship.
- Maratha Confederacy.
- Important battle locations.

# Memory Tricks

- **Wadgaon = British Surrender**
- **Salbai = Stops 1st War**
- **Bassein = Bajirao**
- **1818 = End of Peshwa**
- **KSM = Khirki–Sitabuldi–Mahidpur (Final British Victories)**

# Quick Revision (2 Minutes)

- Maratha Confederacy
- Peshwa
- Nana Phadnavis
- Wadgaon
- Warren Hastings
- Goddard
- Ahmedabad
- Bassein
- Salbai

- Bajirao II
- Arthur Wellesley
- Subsidiary Alliance
- Pindaris
- Khirki
- Sitabuldi
- Mahidpur
- Poona
- Gwalior
- Mandasor
- Peshwaship
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